

COUNSEL REVIEW DRAFT — NOT FOR LIVE USE

DGG Voluntary Sworn-Record Format

Counsel Review and Questioning Packet — Washington candidate v1.0

Matter: Digital Ground Game (DGG) voluntary factual-record pilot

Control date: August 30, 2026

Intended reader: Washington outside counsel, commissioned notary, methods/ethics reviewer, and project decision-maker

Recommended posture: Private, Washington-only, in-person, tangible wet-ink, nonpublic Phase 0/1

Status: Public research and form-design draft; not legal advice, a legal opinion, a live participant form, or launch clearance

Companion candidates: operations/DGG_PARTICIPANT_SWORN_STATEMENT_PROTOCOL_v1.1.md and memorandum/WASHINGTON_VOLUNTARY_SWORN_FORMAT_LEGAL_MEMORANDUM_v1.1.md

Decision rule. This packet is designed to make counsel review concrete. It does not claim to be “airtight.” No responsible memorandum can eliminate unknown facts, legal change, adverse authority, or fact-specific application. The correct goal is a traceable draft that states its assumptions, separates strong law from untested theory, presents the strongest objections, and blocks use until named reviewers close the gates assigned to them.

Controlling limitation. A Washington notary may perform and certify a verification on oath or affirmation involving a statement in a record. The notary does not investigate or certify substantive truth, approve DGG’s questions, or convert DGG into a state program. No decision not to participate, decline, qualify, correct, state uncertainty, or consult counsel is evidence of dishonesty.

0. Executive decision brief

0.1 Proposed decision

Approve continued **synthetic design work and nonpublic feasibility testing only**. Do not approve a named participant, public release, remote or electronic notarization, government partnership, official-capacity use, prosecution referral arrangement, or a claim that the format guarantees false-swearing/perjury consequences.

The first operational objective is not to “put an interview under oath.” It is to test a narrower legal object: a short, exact, participant-authored or expressly adopted **Canonical Sworn Record (CSR)** containing standalone factual statements, stated bases, qualifications, a wet-ink signature, and a contemporaneous verification certificate. The ordinary interview and all DGG commentary remain in a separate, expressly unsworn **Public Media Record (PMR)**.

0.2 Current legal assessment

Proposition	Assessment	Consequence
Washington authorizes a verification on oath or affirmation of a statement in a tangible record.	Strong statutory support	A narrow signed CSR is legally plausible.
A notary certifies substantive truth or state approval.	Incorrect	Repeat the limitation beside every form, clip, and publication.
A knowingly false statement in this private format necessarily violates RCW 9A.72.040.	Plausible text; untested application	Counsel-only disclosure; no promise of liability, prosecution, or conviction.
A private DGG verification is necessarily an “official proceeding” for first-degree perjury.	Colorable text; unresolved and weak as a product claim	Do not call it a perjury interview or use felony rhetoric.
Notarization makes the CSR true, admissible, self-authenticating for all purposes, or conclusive proof.	Incorrect/overbroad	Hearsay, relevance, authentication, completeness, best-evidence, and privilege issues remain.
An independent state-commissioned notary makes all DGG editorial conduct state action.	Not supported categorically	Keep the notarial act discrete and private; reanalyze any governmental direction, joint action, compulsion, or entwinement.
A private, unfunded study automatically falls under the Common Rule.	Incorrect	Obtain an HRPP/IRB determination anyway before randomized or publishable human-subject data collection.

Proposition	Assessment	Consequence
Government sponsorship would be a cosmetic change.	Incorrect	Treat it as a new intervention and a new public-law project.

0.3 Why the format may still be useful

The defensible civic value does not depend on punishment. The format may create a better evidence object by making these features inspectable:

- one proposition at a time;
- the participant's complete standalone statement rather than a bare "yes" or "no";
- personal-knowledge versus record-based basis;
- defined scope, exceptions, and qualifications;
- source and strongest contrary-source disclosure;
- exact record ID, version, pages, and proposition index;
- visible uncertainty, lack of recall, inability to verify, and decline without penalty; and
- append-only correction and provenance.

The format fails if the notarial cue raises trust without accuracy, if refusal becomes a dishonesty label, if participants become more evasive, or if a government connection produces perceived compulsion or official endorsement.

0.4 Counsel decision requested

Counsel should return one of four decisions for each component: **approve as drafted; approve with written conditions; hold for facts/research; or do not approve.** Counsel is not asked to certify that the project is risk-free. Counsel is asked to identify the lawful form, the factual assumptions, the remaining risks, and the conditions that must precede each phase.

I. Project statement: what it is, how it is used, and why

1. The project in one paragraph

DGG proposes a private, optional format in which a willing adult reviews a short set of disclosed factual propositions, authors or expressly adopts complete standalone answers, states the basis and qualifications for each answer, and—only after the exact paper record is frozen—signs the selected statements under an oath or affirmation administered by an independent Washington notary. DGG may then conduct a separate ordinary interview. The notary certifies the notarial act and required determinations, not factual truth. The first phases are nonpublic and use only synthetic or fully consented materials.

2. Intended uses

2.1 Authorized design uses

1. **Memorandum building.** Analysts can connect a factual proposition to supporting and contrary sources, authorities, qualifications, and corrections.
2. **Question discipline.** Interviewers must define actor, conduct, date, scope, unit, and knowledge route before asking.
3. **Evidence literacy.** Viewers can distinguish a claim about an underlying event from a claim that a record says something.
4. **Calibration research.** Researchers can test accuracy, uncertainty, source inspection, correction, coercion, and audience overtrust.
5. **Detective practice.** A reviewer can reproduce the reasoning chain instead of accepting a commentator's confidence.

2.2 Uses that are not authorized

- a truth-certification service, honesty score, red/green credibility badge, or public blacklist;
- a free-form “interview under oath”;
- a government hearing, official investigation, ballot/debate qualification, employment screen, licensing condition, benefit condition, or law-enforcement intake;
- a device for threatening a participant with prosecution or reputational punishment;
- an automatic evidentiary shortcut;
- a substitute for fact-checking, discovery, cross-examination, source verification, or counsel; or
- a national or remote protocol inferred from Washington's current in-person paper design.

3. Why advance disclosure and voluntary participation are core controls

Advance disclosure is designed to reduce accidental falsity and coercion. It permits the participant to inspect records, correct premises, identify privilege or confidentiality concerns, distinguish personal knowledge from staff reporting, consult independent counsel, and decide that an item belongs in the unsworn lane. The process is not a memory contest or surprise examination.

Voluntariness applies at four levels: the entire format, each question, the precise wording of each adopted statement, and publication. A participant may stop, qualify, state uncertainty, decline, or request counsel. DGG must not attach a dishonesty inference or a practical penalty to any choice.

4. Record architecture

Record	Contents	Sworn status	Controller
Canonical Sworn Record (CSR)	Exact adopted statements, basis, qualifications, proposition index, signature, jurat	Only identified adopted content is sworn	Participant authors/adopts; custodian preserves; notary controls act/certificate
Public Media Record (PMR)	Interview, video, audio, transcript, commentary, source analysis, clips	Unsworn	DGG editorial team, subject to release and publication controls
Source packet	Supporting and materially contrary sources, search record, source limits	Unsworn unless exact text is deliberately incorporated	Fact editor
Administration packet	Invitation, consents, manifest, custody, incident and correction logs	Unsworn	Assigned controllers
Notary records	Journal and any legally required notarial records	Separate; not part of CSR/PMR	Notary under applicable law
Counsel file	Legal advice, sign-offs, assumptions, issue list	Not part of public CSR; privilege is not guaranteed	Counsel/client under engagement terms

The CSR must never incorporate the PMR or source packet by blanket reference. A later clip, caption, edit, or host statement cannot expand the oath.

II. Government relationship and state-action boundary

5. Recommended Phase 1 position

DGG is a private, voluntary media/research project with one regulated legal interface: an independent Washington-commissioned notary performs a discrete notarial act. The commission authorizes the notary; it does not make DGG state-sponsored, state-approved, or a government truth tribunal.

This is a fact-specific position, not a categorical immunity. State-action analysis focuses on the challenged conduct. The Supreme Court identifies limited routes such as performance of a traditional exclusive public function, government compulsion, and joint action. Licensing, public-interest purpose, regulation, and even a contract do not alone answer the question. Government coercion, significant encouragement, joint participation, or pervasive entwinement can change the result. See *Manhattan Community Access Corp. v. Halleck*, *Lugar v. Edmondson Oil Co.*, *Blum v. Yaretsky*, *Rendell-Baker v. Kohn*, and *Brentwood Academy v. Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Ass'n*.

6. Government-connection matrix

Configuration	Federal constitutional risk	Public-records/ethics risk	Disposition
Independent notary; private DGG questions, custody, funding, and publication	Low for DGG editorial conduct on present assumptions; notarial conduct remains state-authorized	Low if no agency prepares, owns, uses, or retains records	Recommended private posture
Public official participates solely in personal or campaign capacity	Capacity and campaign facts may create disputes	Medium if public staff, devices, records, or official business are involved	Written capacity statement and separate ethics/campaign advice
Public venue, staff, logo, equipment, official promotion, or in-kind support	Joint-action/endorsement appearance rises	Medium to high	Prohibited in Phase 1
Government grant or service contract	Contract alone not dispositive; direction and deliverables matter	Procurement, audit, retention, disclosure, and functional-equivalency risk	New memorandum before acceptance
Agency selects participants, questions, sources, labels, or release timing	High joint-action/compulsion risk	High	Prohibited absent redesigned public program

Configuration	Federal constitutional risk	Public-records/ethics risk	Disposition
Participation or answer affects employment, benefit, license, contract, access, candidacy, or investigation	Very high speech, unconstitutional-conditions, due-process, equal-protection, and section 1983 risk	High	Absolute prohibition for this design
Standing law-enforcement referral, live feed, raw-data access, or targeted collection request	High joint-action and privacy/search risk	High	No arrangement; valid legal process only under counsel
Government-created or government-dominated entity/advisory board	High entwinement risk	High functional-equivalency/OPMA risk	New entity-wide memorandum

7. Washington public-records and public-resource consequences

DGG is not an agency merely because it uses a commissioned notary. But the Washington Public Records Act covers writings relating to government conduct that an agency prepares, owns, uses, or retains. Official-capacity messages can be public records even on a private device. [Chapter 42.56 RCW](#); *Nissen v. Pierce County*.

A private entity may also become the functional equivalent of an agency for disclosure purposes. The Washington Supreme Court's 2025 *Horvath* opinion applies the nonexclusive *Telford* factors—governmental function, public funding, government involvement, and government creation—along with the PRA's transparency purpose. *Horvath v. DBIA Services*. Federal state action and Washington functional-equivalency are different tests; failure of one does not decide the other.

Official participation may also implicate:

- state ethics and use of public resources under [chapter 42.52 RCW](#);
- municipal conflicts and special privileges under [chapter 42.23 RCW](#);
- state procurement and contracting under [chapter 39.26 RCW](#);
- data-sharing agreements, security classification, and audit rights, including [RCW 39.26.340](#);
- public retention under [chapter 40.14 RCW](#); and
- open meetings if a public body is created or performs delegated public work under [chapter 42.30 RCW](#).

8. Phase 1 government-separation rules

1. Use this exact statement on forms and publications: **“DGG is a private project. No government agency sponsors, approves, or verifies this content.”**
2. Describe the officer only as an **independent Washington-commissioned notary**.
3. Keep the notary outside question selection, source assessment, editorial scoring, participant ranking, and publication.
4. Use no government seal, agency logo, official account, government venue, public staff, or public equipment.
5. Accept no public grant, contract, in-kind support, data feed, or referral arrangement in Phase 1.
6. Permit no agency to choose participants, propositions, sources, labels, or release timing.
7. Create no consequence for refusal, qualification, correction, withdrawal, or uncertainty.
8. Maintain separate DGG, participant, counsel, and notary records.
9. Promise no absolute confidentiality against subpoena, warrant, court order, discovery, or later public-record status.
10. Allow government access only through valid legal process or a separately approved agreement after a new memorandum.

9. Automatic new-memorandum triggers

A fresh signed legal review is required before accepting public money; contracting with an agency or public university; transferring identifiable records to government; involving a public employee in official capacity; co-branding with government; forming a public-official advisory board; allowing an agency to direct content; connecting participation to any government consequence; creating a referral/data-access arrangement; or claiming official status, evidentiary effect, endorsement, or government verification.

If government becomes involved, counsel must separately analyze the First Amendment, unconstitutional conditions, due process, equal protection, privacy, procurement, records, ethics, disability access, and remedies. A government “truth” or refusal label would be especially vulnerable. See *United States v. Alvarez*, *Agency for International Development v. Alliance for Open Society International*, *Paul v. Davis*, *Board of Regents v. Roth*, and *Mathews v. Eldridge*.

III. Professional questioning standard

10. Design rule

The interviewer's question is not itself sworn. The participant's **complete standalone adopted statement**, stated basis, and printed qualification are the only substantive sworn content. A bare "yes" or "no" is prohibited because it can silently import disputed premises from DGG-authored wording.

The question, supporting and contrary sources, DGG analysis, interviewer commentary, decline status, and counsel approvals remain expressly unsworn unless exact text is deliberately incorporated in a standalone adopted statement.

11. Question-admission test

A proposed item may enter the drafting schedule only if every applicable box is checked:

- ☐ It asks about a verifiable past or present fact, not opinion, advocacy, prediction, motive, character, or moral judgment.
- ☐ It contains one proposition; a single answer cannot be true in one respect and false in another.
- ☐ It identifies the actor, act/event/condition, relevant date or period, and place when material.
- ☐ Material terms, units, thresholds, exceptions, and comparison sets are defined neutrally.
- ☐ It avoids an unbounded "always," "never," or universal negative unless the search universe is defined.
- ☐ It does not presume misconduct or embed a disputed accusation.
- ☐ It can be answered from personal knowledge, identified records, or a precisely limited combination.
- ☐ The participant received the exact wording, definitions, and source/counter-source packet in advance.
- ☐ A similarly situated person with different politics would receive materially the same formulation.
- ☐ DGG has stated what each response would and would not establish.
- ☐ No located evidence makes the proposed response known or probably false or materially misleading.
- ☐ Legal/media review has considered defamation, false light, privilege, privacy, campaign, and recording issues.

- ☐ The sworn format adds a reasoned value beyond ordinary reporting.

Any unchecked item moves to the unsworn lane, returns for revision, or is rejected.

12. Response taxonomy

The exact adopted statement controls if any response code conflicts with its text.

Code	Response path	What may be adopted
T-PK	True — personal knowledge	A complete factual statement within stated personal knowledge
F-PK	False — personal knowledge	A complete factual denial within stated personal knowledge
T-R	True — identified records	Prefer “the identified record states X” unless the records and capacity support the underlying event
F-R	False — identified records	State the defined record universe and search/verification limit
Q	Qualified	Complete proposition with every material limit and exception on the same page
U	Unknown	“As of [time], I do not know whether [defined proposition] is true.”
R	Not recalled	“As of [time], I do not presently recall facts sufficient to answer [defined proposition].”
V	Cannot verify	“After reviewing [identified materials], I cannot verify whether [defined proposition] is true.”
D	Decline	No underlying proposition or knowledge-state assertion is sworn; omit from the Adopted Proposition Index

Counsel must decide whether U, R, and V are sworn statements about present knowledge, recall, or verification ability, or merely administrative responses. The form below permits inclusion only through the Adopted Proposition Index. A decline is never included.

13. Questioning sequence

13.1 Green zone — unsworn review

1. Confirm written consent and that no recording/transcription system is active before the approved consent condition.

2. Explain the sworn/unsworn boundary, right to counsel, response taxonomy, no-inference rule, and correction process.
3. Present the exact question, definitions, support, and strongest contrary material.
4. Ask the participant to identify the proposition they are actually prepared to state—not merely answer “yes” or “no.”
5. Ask for the basis: personal observation/action, communication, identified record, combination, or present knowledge state.
6. Ask for every limit, exception, date qualification, capacity qualification, and contrary fact.
7. Read the complete standalone proposed statement back. The participant or participant’s counsel authors or expressly adopts it.
8. If a follow-up changes substance, create a new draft; do not treat oral clarification as part of the future oath.

Permitted neutral prompts include: “What exact date range can you support?”; “Are you stating what the record says, or that the underlying event occurred?”; “What exception should appear in the sentence?”; and “What facts are outside your personal knowledge?”

Prohibited prompts include: “Are you sure you want to risk perjury?”; “Why won’t you tell the truth?”; “A decline will look bad”; “Just answer yes or no”; and any threat, promised benefit, preferred-answer coaching, or publicity leverage.

13.2 Amber zone — freeze

Generate the final paper record and external pre-sign manifest. Reconcile ID, version, page count, proposition index, all answer fields, qualifications, and certificate attachment. Remove or strike unused blank answer space. The participant initials each sworn-payload page. Any substantive change returns the process to Green and creates a new version.

13.3 Red zone — notarial act

The session lead yields control to the independent notary. The notary—not DGG—decides whether to proceed, determines identity/signature and other required matters, administers the approved oath or affirmation, witnesses the signature, completes the certificate and journal contemporaneously, and may refuse. The notary does **not** approve the proposition content, source sufficiency, legal theory, editorial fairness, or criminal consequences.

13.4 Green zone — close

The notarial act is formally closed. Every later statement is unsworn unless a new complete CSR and notarial act occur. Transfer the original under custody receipt, create the executed-scan digest, perform privacy/redaction review, and hold the record nonpublic in Phases 0 and 1.

14. Drafting examples

Prefer: “Between January 1 and June 30, 2026, did you personally authorize transaction T-014?”

Avoid: “Can you swear you were never bought by special interests?”

Prefer: “As of August 20, 2026, did filed report S-004 list a \$5,000 contribution from Entity X?”

Avoid: “Did Entity X secretly give you money?”

Prefer: “Before making the quoted statement on July 10, 2026, had you personally reviewed document S-009?”

Avoid: “Did you knowingly spread misinformation?”

Even the preferred forms require neutral definitions, source/counter-source disclosure, a material-meaning check, and counsel review.

IV. Detachable question-admission worksheet and CSR form

COUNSEL-REVIEW DRAFT — NOT FOR LIVE USE. The following form is designed only for an in-person, tangible, wet-ink Washington pilot. Washington counsel must approve the declaration, oath or affirmation, certificate selection, participant notice, publication use, and each question set. The commissioned notary must remain free to use a lawful equivalent procedure or refuse the act.

15. Internal question-admission worksheet

INTERNAL / UNSWORN / NOT PART OF THE CSR. Treat legal analysis as potentially privileged and keep it separate from any public CSR. Privilege depends on client, purpose, audience, and confidentiality; this label does not create privilege.

Question ID: Q-_____

Proposed Proposition ID: P-_____

Participant/capacity: _____

Drafter: _____ Independent reviewer: _____

Draft date: _____ Advance-disclosure date: _____

15.1 Exact proposed question

15.2 Precision fields

Field	Entry
Actor	
Act, event, condition, or record state	
Beginning date/time	
Ending date/time or “as of” date	
Place/jurisdiction if material	
Amount, unit, threshold, or comparison set	
Defined terms	
Express exclusions/exceptions	
Participant capacity and knowledge boundary	

15.3 Material-meaning matrix

A true response would establish only:

A false response would establish only:

Neither response would establish:

Potential misleading implication and control:

15.4 Source and counter-source disclosure

Supporting Source Packet ID/version: _____

Source ID	Exact page/section	Proposition supported	Reliability/adverse limit
S-____			

Strongest Contrary Source Packet ID/version: _____

Source ID	Exact page/section	Contrary/limiting proposition	Reliability/adverse limit
C-____			

If no materially contrary source was located, list the databases, search terms, date range, and search date. Write “**none located**,” never “**none exists**.”

Disposition of contrary material: [] no change [] revise question [] require qualification [] remove [] further research

15.5 Special-risk exclusions

Hold the item for counsel if it concerns an active civil/criminal/administrative matter; possible self-incrimination; classified, sealed, privileged, protected whistleblower, health, education, tax, personnel, trade-secret, confidential-source, or NDA material; a private third party; sexual conduct; medical/disability status; minors; biometric/health inference; or information the participant may not lawfully disclose.

15.6 Admission disposition

- ☐ Admit to proposed CSR

- ☐ Return for revision
- ☐ Move to unsworn interview
- ☐ Reject
- ☐ Hold for evidence or specialist counsel

Fact editor: _____ **Date:** _____

Legal/media reviewer: _____ **Date:** _____

Reason and conditions: _____

The notary does not approve substantive content, source adequacy, legal meaning, or editorial fairness. The notary reviews only whether the fixed workflow and counsel-selected certificate can be performed within the notary's lawful role.

16. CSR document-control cover

UNSWORN ADMINISTRATIVE PAGE — NOT ADOPTED AS FACTUAL CONTENT

Canonical Sworn Record ID: CSR-_____

Version: _____

Manifest ID: _____

Session date: _____

Actual Washington venue/county: _____

Participant public name/capacity: _____

Total CSR pages: _____

Sworn-payload pages: _____ through _____

Adopted Proposition IDs: _____

Original custodian: _____

Required participant-rights notice

Participation and every proposition are voluntary. The participant may decline the process or any item; qualify an answer; state lack of knowledge, lack of recall, or inability to verify; request counsel, accommodation, interpreter/translation assistance, or a break; or stop before completion. No adverse inference may be drawn from any such choice.

The notary performs and certifies the notarial act and required statutory determinations. The notary does not investigate the sources or certify that the participant's statements are factually true. Legal consequences, admissibility, and jurisdiction are fact-specific; DGG makes no promise about them.

Language used: _____ **Interpreter/reader/accommodation, if any:** _____

Counsel approval reference: _____ **Form approval date:** _____

17. One-question schedule — repeat for each proposition

QUESTION AND SOURCE AREA — UNSWORN

Question ID: Q-_____

Proposed Proposition ID: P-_____

Question disclosed on: _____

Source Packet ID/version: _____

Contrary Source Packet ID/version: _____

17.1 Interviewer's exact question

17.2 Scope and definitions

The question, DGG annotations, and source descriptions provide context. They are not adopted merely because they appear on this page.

PARTICIPANT STATEMENT AREA — POTENTIALLY SWORN

17.3 Response path

Select one. The complete exact adopted statement below controls.

- ☐ True — personal knowledge
- ☐ False — personal knowledge
- ☐ True — based on identified records reviewed
- ☐ False — based on identified records reviewed
- ☐ Qualified answer
- ☐ I do not know whether the proposition is true
- ☐ I do not presently recall facts sufficient to answer
- ☐ I cannot verify from the identified records available to me
- ☐ Decline — no sworn assertion; omit from the Adopted Proposition Index

17.4 Exact adopted statement

Write a complete standalone sentence. Do not write only “yes,” “no,” or “same as above.”

17.5 Basis of knowledge

- ☐ Personal observation or action
- ☐ Communication personally sent or received
- ☐ Identified record personally reviewed
- ☐ Combination, limited below
- ☐ Present knowledge, recall, or ability-to-verify statement only

Exact record ID, title, date, and page/section relied upon:

What the record establishes and does not establish:

For a record-based answer, distinguish “**the identified record states X**” from “**X actually occurred.**” Review of a record may support the first without personal ability to establish the second.

17.6 Qualifications, limits, and exceptions

Write “None” only after review.

17.7 Participant freeze confirmation

- ☐ The exact adopted statement is mine or has been expressly adopted by me.
- ☐ My complete qualification appears immediately above.
- ☐ I reviewed the identified contrary material or had a meaningful opportunity to do so.
- ☐ I understand what this statement does and does not assert.
- ☐ I request inclusion of P-_____ in the Adopted Proposition Index.

Participant initials: _____ **Freeze date/time:** _____

18. Adopted Proposition Index

SWORN SCOPE CONTROL. Only entries listed below are included. A declined item must not appear.

Proposition ID	Page	Statement type	Qualification present
P-____		fact / record-state / knowledge-state	yes / no

Proposition ID	Page	Statement type	Qualification present
P-____		fact / record-state / knowledge-state	yes / no

Excluded Question IDs: _____

19. Participant adoption and signature

PROPOSED LANGUAGE — WASHINGTON COUNSEL MUST APPROVE

I, **[printed name]**, voluntarily make this signed record as a sworn statement.

I have read, or had read to me, CSR **[record ID]**, version **[version]**, pages **[sworn page range]**. I adopt only:

1. the complete text in each “Exact adopted statement” field listed in the Adopted Proposition Index;
2. the basis-of-knowledge statement printed with each adopted proposition; and
3. every qualification, limit, and exception printed with that proposition.

I state that each adopted statement is true as written and qualified.

If an adopted statement says that I do not know, do not recall, or cannot verify a proposition, I swear only to that stated condition of my present knowledge, recall, or ability to verify. I do not thereby affirm or deny the underlying proposition. A declined item makes no sworn assertion and is not included in the Adopted Proposition Index.

I do not adopt the interviewer’s questions, DGG source annotations, contrary-source annotations, editorial assessments, public-media content, or later commentary except to the extent exact text is expressly incorporated into an adopted statement.

I understand that the notarial officer performs and certifies the notarial act and required determinations; the officer does not investigate or certify the factual truth of my statements.

I intend this signed record, limited as stated above, to be represented as my sworn statement under the oath or affirmation administered before the notarial officer.

Participant signature: _____

Printed name: _____

Date/time signed: _____

The participant must not pre-sign. Counsel must determine the exact signature/appearance requirement for the selected act.

Proposed oath or affirmation script

Notarial officer: “Do you swear or affirm that every statement you adopted in CSR [record ID], version [version], including its stated basis and every printed qualification, is true?”

Participant: “I do.”

Washington law does not supply this project-specific script. Counsel must approve it. The independent notary must remain free to use a lawful equivalent or refuse.

20. Washington verification certificate

NOTARIAL OFFICER ONLY. Do not prefill the date, appearing individual's name, notary signature, title, commission expiration, or stamp. The officer must execute the certificate contemporaneously; a tangible-record certificate must be part of or securely attached to the record. [RCW 42.45.130](#).

Administrative document reference: CSR ID _____, version _____, pages _____ of _____.

The following is Washington's current statutory short form for a verification on oath or affirmation:

State of Washington
County of _____
Signed and sworn to (or affirmed) before me on _____ by
_____.

Signature of notary public
[Official stamp]

Title of office
My commission expires: _____

Source: [RCW 42.45.140\(3\)](#). Counsel must recheck the current official text immediately before use.

21. Internal notarial-act control sheet

INTERNAL / UNSWORN / NOT PART OF CSR / NOT FOR PUBLICATION. This records workflow completion; it does not ask the notary to approve content or give legal advice.

- ☐ Active Washington commission checked independently.
- ☐ Notary and participant physically present as required; actual venue/county confirmed.
- ☐ Conflict/direct-beneficial-interest and enhanced independence screen completed.
- ☐ Correct CSR ID, version, page count, and proposition index confirmed.
- ☐ No missing, substituted, altered, pre-signed, or post-freeze page.
- ☐ Notary independently determined whether to proceed and made required identity/signature determinations.
- ☐ Oath or affirmation administered; participant signed while appearing.

- ☐ Certificate completed, signed, dated, stamped, and securely attached contemporaneously.
- ☐ Applicable journal/documentation requirement completed. Counsel addresses the attorney-notary exception in RCW 42.45.180(2).
- ☐ No identity document, address, journal, credential, or stamp-control information entered production capture.
- ☐ Notarial act formally closed before later commentary.

Operational exception or refusal: _____

DGG must not seek a copy of the notary's journal or credentials. The notary should retain this control sheet only if consistent with the notary's own policies and counsel's direction.

22. Correction and invalidation control

INTERNAL / UNSWORN

CSR ID/version: _____

- ☐ Draft changed before freeze — replacement version issued.
- ☐ Frozen record changed before execution — prior version marked **VOID / NOT EXECUTED** and quarantined.
- ☐ Act interrupted or defective — no completion claimed; clean version and complete new act required.
- ☐ Executed original — no interlineation, erasure, replacement page, whiteout, detachment, or overwrite.
- ☐ Administrative/transcription notice issued outside the CSR.
- ☐ Substantive correction requires new CSR/version and complete new oath, signature, certificate, documentation, manifest, and custody chain.
- ☐ Publication derivative corrected, restricted, or replaced with a provenance notice under counsel direction.

Superseded record: _____ **New record:** _____

Classification/reason: _____

Counsel disposition: _____

Record-controller signature/date: _____

A project correction is an integrity control. It is not a promise that Washington's narrow statutory retraction defense applies. [RCW 9A.72.060](#).

23. Public-copy and privacy rule

The executed paper original remains preserved under restricted custody. Any later public copy is a separately generated, access-safe derivative approved by media/privacy counsel. Counsel must decide whether to redact or mask participant signatures, notary signatures/stamps, addresses, commission/security information, QR/bar codes, manifest internals, and third-party personal data while preserving a verifiable provenance path. “Complete package” means complete substantive context, not indiscriminate publication of security-relevant data.

V. Legal argument and counterargument matrix

24. Notarial authority and criminal-law theory

Issue	Best affirmative argument	Strongest limit/adverse argument	Control and present disposition
Verification on oath	Chapter 42.45 RCW defines and authorizes a verification involving a statement in a record; RCW 5.28.010 lists notaries among oath administrators.	Wrong act/certificate, defective attachment, altered record, venue/identity/signature defect, conflict, or ambiguous adoption can defeat the intended act.	Exact counsel-approved paper form; notary procedural review; version/page controls. Approve only as model architecture.
Notary role	RCW 42.45.130 supports a contemporaneous certificate of the act.	Visual/legal theater can falsely imply state truth certification; the certificate is not a factual investigation.	Adjacent limitation notice; no government seals/badges; comprehension gate. Strong limitation required.
False swearing	RCW 9A.72.040 reaches a knowingly false statement under an oath required or authorized by law; RCW 9A.72.010(5) includes an oath administered by a legally authorized officer.	No located reported Washington appellate case applies the offense to this private political-media design; knowledge, exact oath, representation, territorial jurisdiction, constitutional application, charging, and proof remain.	Describe as the most textually plausible candidate offense , not a result. No threats/referral promises. Internal/counsel use.
First-degree perjury	RCW 9A.72.010(4) includes some proceedings before a notary; RCW 9A.72.020 adds materiality.	A private verification may not be a proceeding “heard before” the notary; materiality is unclear; <i>Smith/Otton</i> are evidence-rule analogies.	Current citator and formal opinion. Block participant-facing and promotional use.
Knowledge/qualification	RCW 9A.72.080 treats certain unqualified unknown statements as knowingly false.	Blanket “knowledge and belief” wording may blur direct truth declaration, record-basis, and mental-state statements.	Standalone sentence; basis and qualification on same page; counsel decides U/R/V treatment.
Correction/retraction	New versions and append-only provenance reduce editorial harm.	RCW 9A.72.060’s defense is narrow and fact-specific.	Say project correction is not promised statutory retraction.
Territorial jurisdiction	In-person Washington facts reduce avoidable uncertainty.	Washington location does not settle all criminal jurisdiction, and nationwide publication creates multistate civil choice-of-law and personal-jurisdiction risk.	Phase 1 physically Washington; no jurisdiction/extradition claim; multistate publication memo before Phase 3.

25. Evidence, admissibility, privilege, and legal process

Notarization does **not** establish that a statement is true, admissible for its truth, complete, privileged, or automatically self-authenticating in every proceeding. Washington's evidence rules require case-specific analysis of relevance, authentication, hearsay and exceptions, completeness, original/duplicate rules, privilege, and—where criminal use is contemplated—constitutional confrontation and voluntariness issues. [Washington Rules of Evidence](#).

Issue	Risk	Required rule
Authentication/self-authentication	A jurat and signature may help prove execution but do not authenticate all source materials or prove truth. ER 902(h) concerns acknowledged documents and should not be overextended to this jurat without counsel.	Call the CSR an audit/research record; make no automatic-admissibility claim.
Hearsay/completeness	A participant's out-of-court assertion and DGG republication may face multiple hearsay and context questions.	Preserve complete context and source provenance; counsel identifies any offered purpose/exception.
Privilege	DGG counsel, participant counsel, and research counsel may represent different clients; third parties and recording can defeat confidentiality.	Written engagement/client map; privilege-safe channels; keep counsel file out of CSR/PMR/repository.
Reporter shield	RCW 5.68.010 may protect qualifying news media/newsgathering records but status, activity, record type, and exceptions are fact-specific.	No promise of immunity; media-counsel opinion; separate editorial/research/admin stores.
Subpoena/discovery/legal hold	Private records remain discoverable or subpoenaable; vendor copies exist; deletion may be suspended.	Named legal-demand custodian; request log; counsel review; preservation; narrow lawful production; participant notice when lawful.
Self-incrimination/active matters	A voluntary CSR may be used against a speaker; government cooperation or threats increase risk.	Independent participant counsel; exclude active/privileged/classified/sealed matters absent specialized written review.

26. Publication, privacy, and intellectual-property matrix

Issue	Supportive position	Adverse position	Control/disposition
Defamation/public-figure rules	Exact participant adoption, source disclosure, public-interest context, and corrections improve care; public officials may face actual-malice standards.	DGG writes questions/headlines, edits and republishes; a literally true fragment can imply a defamatory meaning; named private third parties may have lower burdens.	Plaintiff-by-plaintiff classification, source verification file, implication audit, complete context, prepublication counsel. Block named publication pending review.
False light/private facts/intrusion	Narrow factual wording and pre-capture consent reduce risk.	Washington recognizes privacy-related theories; consent to record is not consent to every publication or inference.	Separate privacy/false-light/private-facts review; minimize sensitive content; no surprise capture.
Personality/likeness	Chapter 63.60 contains conditional political, news, public-interest, article/program, and campaign exemptions.	Advertising, promotion, fundraising, forged/synthetic likeness, false endorsement, or commercial uses may fall outside an exemption or trigger separate duties.	Use-by-use written release; separate AI/translation/promotion /fundraising permissions; no inaccurate endorsement.
Recording	RCW 9.73.030 recognizes consent routes.	Consent obtained only after recording begins, late joiners, ambient capture, and interstate rules create risk; recording consent is not publication consent.	Signed layered consent before capture plus recorded confirmation; room/device control; state-law matrix if anyone is elsewhere.
Copyright/source publication	Linking and limited public-domain/licensed excerpts support transparency.	Full source packets may contain copyrighted, confidential, sealed, private, or trade-secret material; fair use is fact-specific.	Prefer links and public records; source-by-source license/fair-use review; do not publish privileged/confidential sources.
AI/biometrics/health inference	AI may assist accessibility or transcription with consent.	Voiceprints, face templates, health/disability inference, and consumer-health data may implicate chapters 19.375, 19.373, 19.255 RCW and vendor terms.	Default ban on biometric enrollment/inference; vendor data-flow review; separate consent, minimization, security, deletion, and breach plan.
Multistate distribution	Washington controls the act performed there.	Online republication can create other states' defamation, privacy, publicity, recording, and choice-of-law issues.	Phase 3 distribution memo and geographies/use inventory.

27. Campaign, entity, tax, and consumer-protection matrix

Issue	Possible favorable argument	Principal risk	Gate
Press/news function	Washington/federal law contain conditional press/news exclusions and FEC authority recognizes some internet media acting in a press function.	Candidate request, ownership/control, material involvement, payment, below-market services, or coordinated distribution may create contributions/expenditures.	Actual entity, funding, editorial-control, valuation, contact, and distribution facts; PDC/FEC counsel.
Washington reporting	Editorially independent media activity may fall outside some campaign rules.	Title 29B definitions and low reporting thresholds are fact-specific.	Written Washington election-counsel classification before any candidate service/spending.
Section 501(c)(4)	Some political activity is permitted.	Political campaign intervention cannot be primary; section 527(f), reporting, private-benefit, and restricted-fund issues remain.	Verify entity/EIN/status/governing documents/filings; tax counsel; time and cost accounting.
Marketing/consumer protection	Careful limitation language can accurately explain the process.	“Verified truth,” “certified accurate,” or guaranteed-consequence marketing may be deceptive even apart from defamation.	Approved claims matrix; no truth badge or prosecution promise; correction of misleading promotion.
Insurance/indemnity	Written vendor and participant agreements can allocate some duties.	Indemnity cannot replace compliance, may be unenforceable or inequitable, and coverage may exclude intentional/publication claims.	Media/E&O, cyber, D&O and event coverage review; do not demand participant indemnity as coercive substitute.

28. Accessibility, language, and equal-participation controls

Accessibility is both a legal and validity issue. Depending on facts, ADA Title III, Washington’s Law Against Discrimination, contractual duties, and—if government/federal funding is involved—Title II or section 504 may apply. The project must not treat an accommodation request, use of an interpreter, slower response, reading assistance, or inability to use a standard form as an honesty signal.

Before real-person feasibility work, provide an accessible venue; accessible electronic review copy; readable type and plain-language notice; screen-reader-compatible material; captions/transcripts where authorized; qualified interpreter/translation protocol; extra review time; a method to record who read or translated the exact text; and a counsel-approved way to preserve semantic equivalence. Translation and accommodation do not authorize changing the proposition after freeze.

VI. Research and evidence plan

29. Research questions

Study	Core question	Recommended comparison	Co-primary outcomes
Audience halo	Does sworn/notarial framing increase belief independent of accuracy?	Identical fictional claims crossed with ordinary/accuracy-commitment/sworn cues and accurate/inaccurate/indeterminate reference status	Calibration; false belief that notary verified truth
Limitation language	Can an adjacent explanation neutralize the truth halo?	Cue with and without limitation language	Correct role comprehension; raw and calibrated trust
Status stigma	Do “declined,” “not published,” qualification, or correction labels imply dishonesty?	Separate randomized vignettes	Dishonesty inference; perceived coercion; willingness to hear speaker
Speaker process	Does the process improve assertions or increase evasion/decline?	Ordinary evidence interview vs plain accuracy commitment vs simulated CSR	False-assertion rate across assigned resolvable items; epistemically appropriate response rate
Incremental value	Does legal ritual add value beyond advance questions and a plain commitment?	Factorial/dismantling design	Incremental effect with equivalence/futility test
Government cue	Does sponsorship increase compulsion, endorsement, or truth-certification belief?	Private sponsor vs neutral public institution vs agency vignette; no operational partnership	Voluntariness, endorsement, false-certification belief

30. Human-subjects decision path

1. **Journalism or research?** A case-specific portrayal of one person may fit the scholarly/journalistic activity category deemed not “research.” A systematic randomized study designed to generalize about the format is research. [45 CFR 46.102](#).
2. **Human subjects?** Direct interaction, audiovisual capture, manipulation, or identifiable private information can create human-subject research.
3. **Does the Common Rule legally apply?** It generally applies when a Common Rule agency conducts or supports the research; a private unfunded study is not automatically covered, but an institution may extend its FWA/policies. [OHRP lesson](#).

4. **Possible exemption?** Some low-risk adult survey/vignette or benign-behavioral work may fit 45 CFR 46.104, subject to identifiability, disclosure risk, prospective agreement, deception rules, and limited review. Do not self-classify an operative oath with identifiable publication and potential legal/reputational exposure as benign.
5. **Written determination.** Obtain a written HRPP/IRB determination before randomized or publishable data collection and before any real-person speaker experiment. Use [OHRP's decision charts](#) and the full regulatory text.
6. **Independent ethics even if uncovered.** Consent, risk minimization, equitable selection, monitoring, privacy, confidentiality, third-party/community harm, and adverse-event review remain necessary even if federal regulation does not attach.

31. Measurement rules

The speaker primary endpoint should be false assertions across **all assigned objectively resolvable items**, not accuracy only among answered items, which rewards selective decline. Code accurate assertion, false assertion, appropriate qualification, appropriate unknown/not-verifiable, decline, evasion/irrelevance, and indeterminate reference status separately.

Use a preregistered reference-adjudication protocol, not a claim of “ground truth” for disputed political facts: defined evidence packet, two blinded coders, independent adjudicator, disagreement/uncertainty code, and public criteria. Audience models should account for participant, item, and speaker variation. Report intent-to-treat, uptake, attrition, exclusions, missingness, coder reliability, effect sizes, confidence intervals, multiplicity, and partisan interactions.

Do not exclude participants from primary analyses merely because they fail a post-treatment manipulation check.

32. Candidate safety bounds and stopping rules

An independent statistician must finalize powered thresholds. Candidate gates are:

- observed notary-role comprehension at least 90%, with a one-sided 95% lower confidence bound at least 85%;
- upper 95% confidence bound for increased false truth-certification belief below 5 percentage points;
- upper 95% confidence bound for status-label dishonesty inference below standardized $d = 0.15$;
- no practically meaningful partisan interaction under preregistered equivalence bounds;
- a prespecified accuracy or calibration benefit over a plain accuracy commitment, not merely an ordinary interview; and
- zero critical operational incidents.

Immediately suspend enrollment and publication after unconsented capture; ID/journal exposure; wrong-version execution; post-freeze alteration; participant confusion about legal consequences at execution; coercive prosecution/referral rhetoric; identifiable unapproved allegation; known-false/fabricated source; data breach, doxxing, credible threat or severe related distress; or inadvertent public release.

Report critical events within 24 hours to the research lead, safety officer, counsel, and HRPP/IRB when applicable. Restart only after independent review and documented corrective action. Use a prespecified independent harm look; do not repeatedly peek at accumulating results informally.

33. Evidence needed before expansion

Next phase	Required evidence and approvals
Nonpublic feasibility	Repeated synthetic/tabletop passes; counsel-approved form; notary procedure approval; consent/accessibility/security/custody pass; zero critical events
Audience research	Preregistration and HRPP/IRB determination; powered comprehension/no-halo/no-stigma/correction/symmetry design; null/adverse publication commitment
Speaker research	Simulated process first; enough independent speakers/items; benefit over plain commitment without higher evasion, coercion, or correction resistance
Named public use	Separate participant/matter legal review; media/research consent; harassment/correction plan; no high-risk allegations in first case; public-copy redaction; no unresolved serious event
Government-connected use	Independent replication; government-cue safety study; civil-rights/ethics/PRA/procurement/accessibility/data-governance memo; absolute prohibition on tying participation to government benefits or access

VII. Operations, decisions, and launch blockers

34. Required roles

Role	Responsibility	Must not do
Project owner	Scope, budget, phase order	Override legal/notarial/release stop
Participant	Author/adopt answer, basis, qualification	Control notary certificate or DGG source assessment
Participant counsel	Advise participant under separate client relationship	Act as DGG's counsel unless conflicts are resolved in writing
Fact editor	Neutral question/source/counter-source work	Coach a preferred answer or suppress adverse sources
Media counsel	Defamation/privacy/IP/publication review	Represent participant without engagement/conflict analysis
Washington notary	Statutory act and independent refusal	Approve question content, truth, criminal theory, or publicity
Record controller	Version, paper, manifest, custody	Edit substance after freeze
Accessibility/language lead	Equivalent access and semantic fidelity	Infer capacity or honesty from accommodation
Privacy/security lead	Data map, minimization, incident response	Obtain notary journal/ID for production
Legal-demand custodian	Subpoena/discovery/PRA/government-contact routing	Promise secrecy or produce voluntarily without counsel
Methods/ethics reviewer	Preregistration, thresholds, adverse reporting	Convert exploratory results into marketing claims
Independent release authority	Final phase/publication decision	Alter CSR or overrule a legal/privacy block

35. Counsel questions requiring written answers

1. Does the final adoption, oath/affirmation, signature, certificate, attachment, and venue constitute the intended Washington verification?
2. What exact content is sworn and excluded, including U/R/V responses, definitions, bases, qualifications, translations, and incorporated records?
3. What participant-facing description of chapter 9A.72 RCW informs without coercion or legal advice?

4. Does any first-degree-perjury theory remain supportable, and should it remain exclusively privileged?
5. What evidence-law claims, if any, may be made about the CSR?
6. Who is each lawyer's client; who pays; what channels/people preserve or waive privilege; and what conflicts exist?
7. What categories are excluded due to active cases, self-incrimination, privilege, sealed/classified/protected material, third-party rights, or safety?
8. What recording, research, media, AI/biometric, translation, promotion, fundraising, syndication, correction, withdrawal, and retention permissions are required?
9. What public-copy redactions and provenance method protect signatures, stamps, IDs, security details, and third parties?
10. What entity, campaign, press, contribution/expenditure, tax, lobbying, gift, honorarium, insurance, and valuation rules apply?
11. What multistate law applies to national publication or a participant/resident outside Washington?
12. Does DGG qualify as news media under RCW 5.68.010 for this activity and each record category?
13. What records are retained, where, by whom, for how long, under what deletion/legal-hold rule, and with what vendor copies?
14. What HRPP/IRB determination controls each feasibility, audience, and speaker activity?
15. What accommodations, interpreters, and language controls are mandatory?
16. What changes if a government funds, co-designs, receives, relies upon, republishes, or conditions anything on the CSR?

36. Counsel decision sheet

POTENTIALLY PRIVILEGED — KEEP SEPARATE FROM EXECUTED/PUBLIC CSR

Form approval

- ☐ Participant notice and rights approved
- ☐ Standalone statement/basis/qualification structure approved
- ☐ Adoption and U/R/V treatment approved
- ☐ Oath or affirmation language approved
- ☐ Verification-on-oath certificate selected
- ☐ Paper attachment, original custody, public-copy redaction, and correction method approved

- ☐ Notary role limited to lawful procedure

Matter-specific approval

- ☐ Question-admission worksheets complete
- ☐ Defamation/false-light/private-party/source/IP review complete
- ☐ Participant capacity, privilege, self-incrimination, and active-matter review complete
- ☐ Recording, media, research, AI/biometric, accessibility, privacy, retention, and security gates complete
- ☐ Entity/campaign/tax/press/insurance and government-nexus gates complete
- ☐ No known/probable falsity, fabricated source, or material unresolved contradiction
- ☐ Public explanation limits notary role and makes no admissibility/automatic-liability claim

Decision: [] approve as drafted [] approve with conditions [] hold for facts/research [] do not approve

Counsel/reviewer: _____ **Date:** _____

Client and scope: _____

Assumptions, unresolved issues, and conditions: _____

37. Current outside-counsel red-team disposition

- **Approve:** repository drafting, blank forms, synthetic examples, and Phase 0 tabletop testing.
- **Revise before use:** any nonpublic session involving a real person, operative oath, recording, or identifiable data.
- **Block:** named/public use, government partnership, candidate coordination, remote/interstate execution, or claims that the packet is airtight, universally valid, perjury-backed, government-verified, or automatically admissible.

No model form validates its own execution. Validity and risk depend on the exact participant, proposition, source set, oath, certificate, venue, notary, consent, custody, record use, and publication facts.

VIII. Authorities and research architecture

38. Core primary authorities

Washington notary, oath, and criminal statutes

- Chapter 42.45 RCW — Revised Uniform Law on Notarial Acts
- RCW 42.45.130 — certificate requirements
- RCW 42.45.140(3) — verification short form
- RCW 42.45.180 — journal; attorney-notary exception
- RCW 42.45.230 — nonlawyer notary limitations
- RCW 5.28.010 — officers authorized to administer oaths
- Chapter 9A.72 RCW — perjury and false swearing
- RCW 9A.04.030 — territorial jurisdiction
- Chapter 308-30 WAC — notaries public

Publication, government, records, and process

- RCW 9.73.030 — recording consent
- Chapter 63.60 RCW — personality rights
- Washington Rules of Evidence
- RCW 5.68.010 — news-media shield
- Chapter 4.105 RCW — Uniform Public Expression Protection Act
- Chapter 42.56 RCW — Public Records Act
- Chapter 42.52 RCW — Ethics in Public Service
- Chapter 39.26 RCW — procurement
- Chapter 40.14 RCW — public retention
- Chapter 19.375 RCW — biometric identifiers
- Chapter 19.373 RCW — consumer health data
- Chapter 19.255 RCW — private-sector breach notification

State action and open-government cases

- *Manhattan Community Access Corp. v. Halleck*, 587 U.S. 802 (2019)
- *Lugar v. Edmondson Oil Co.*, 457 U.S. 922 (1982)
- *Blum v. Yaretsky*, 457 U.S. 991 (1982)

- [*Rendell-Baker v. Kohn*, 457 U.S. 830 \(1982\)](#)
- [*Brentwood Academy v. TSSAA*, 531 U.S. 288 \(2001\)](#)
- [*Nissen v. Pierce County*, 183 Wn.2d 863 \(2015\)](#)
- [*Horvath v. DBIA Services*, No. 103339-7 \(Wash. Dec. 18, 2025\)](#)

Research regulation

- [45 CFR part 46 — Common Rule](#)
- [HHS OHRP 2018 decision charts](#)
- [HHS OHRP lesson: What is Human Subjects Research?](#)

39. Citation-control warnings

1. Run Shepard's/KeyCite or an equivalent current citator before live use.
2. Verify official reporter text and pinpoints for *Lewis*, *Smith*, *Otton*, *Pearsall-Stipek*, *Hovrud*, *Rickert*, privacy/defamation cases, and every newly added case.
3. Correct *State v. Lewis* to 85 Wn.2d 769, 539 P.2d 677 (1975), subject to final verification.
4. Cite *Rickert v. State, Public Disclosure Commission* as 161 Wn.2d 843, 168 P.3d 826 (2007), subject to current citator review.
5. Treat *Smith* and *Otton* as evidence-rule context, not direct private-media perjury holdings.
6. Recheck RCW/WAC text immediately before use and again at the January 1, 2027 remote-law boundary.
7. Do not cite a project draft as legal authority; cite its statute, rule, case, agency source, or study.

40. Zotero and Obsidian integration

Use stable citekeys and store, for every authority: exact proposition supported, strongest adverse reading, controlling/persuasive/analogy status, date checked, and affected claim/section IDs. Suggested new citekeys include:

washington_rcw_42_45_2026; washington_rcw_9A_72_2026; washington_rcw_42_56_2026; scotus_halleck_2019; scotus_lugar_1982; scotus_blum_1982; scotus_brentwood_2001; wash_nissen_2015; wash_horvath_2025; hhs_common_rule_2018; hhs_ohrp_decision_charts_2020.

Recommended Obsidian notes:

- [[CSR scope - standalone adopted statements]]
- [[Verification versus truth certification]]
- [[False swearing candidate offense - unresolved application]]
- [[Evidence and admissibility are separate from notarization]]
- [[Private notary interface versus state action]]
- [[Government partnership - new memorandum triggers]]
- [[PRA functional equivalency - Horvath and Telford]]
- [[Audience truth halo and refusal stigma]]
- [[Accessibility and semantic equivalence]]
- [[Counsel client and privilege map]]

IX. Process-integrity review

41. Systematic-review audit

This packet is a **targeted, issue-driven legal and empirical synthesis**, not a preregistered systematic review. It used the supplied project files, candidate v1.1 reconciliation, current official statutes/rules, official court opinions where available, official agency materials, and independent adversarial review lanes. It did not claim exhaustive database coverage, duplicate blinded screening, or a complete commercial citator history.

For a publication-grade legal review, counsel should record databases, date limits, jurisdiction filters, terms, citator results, negative treatment, and an adverse-authority log. For the behavioral review, preregister databases, strings, eligibility, duplicate screening, extraction, risk-of-bias assessment, and synthesis; report under PRISMA 2020 where applicable.

Process-integrity judgment: strong enough for a counsel-review candidate and Phase 0 design; not sufficient for live legal reliance or a claim of exhaustive authority.

42. Robustness and meta-analysis critique

The cited evidence streams concern different interventions and outcomes: laboratory honesty commitments, social-media accuracy prompts, political fact-checking, and misinformation correction. Their effect sizes must not be pooled or used directly to power the full DGG intervention. The honesty-commitment literature is heterogeneous and has publication-bias concerns; accuracy-prompt work measures sharing discernment rather than sworn political testimony; political fact-checking weakens in campaign/motivated contexts; corrections often leave residual influence.

There is no defensible meta-analytic effect estimate for the complete DGG protocol. A future review should separately map honesty commitment, accuracy salience, advance disclosure, source transparency, authority/notarial halo, refusal stigma, chilling/selection, and correction. A DGG-specific meta-analysis should wait for multiple independent comparable studies and then use multilevel random-effects methods, dependent-effect handling, heterogeneity and prediction intervals, and sensitivity analyses.

The most important adverse hypotheses are that notarization adds no value over a plain accuracy commitment; increases false certainty; suppresses participation or correction; shifts error into legalistic evasion; or creates partisan/asymmetric invitation and interpretation effects. A credible project must preregister and publish those tests.

43. Final design conclusion

The project has a legally plausible Washington notarial architecture and a serious research rationale. Its strongest form is a private, voluntary, exact, source-linked, participant-controlled record with visible uncertainty and correction. Its weakest form is a dramatic “perjury interview” that depends on a government truth halo or public punishment for declining.

The present packet is therefore **lawyer-facing but not lawyer-approved**. It should let a lawyer see the complete affirmative theory, the strongest objections, the professional form, the government boundary, the research needed, and the decisions still required. Until those decisions are signed, the authorized use remains blank forms, synthetic examples, and Phase 0 tabletop work.

Appendix A. Synthetic worked question block

44. Example purpose and limits

This fictional example demonstrates scope and qualification. It does not involve a real person, campaign, payment, or allegation, and it must not be represented as an executed or legally approved CSR.

QUESTION AND SOURCE AREA — UNSWORN

Question ID: Q-SYN-001

Proposed Proposition ID: P-SYN-001

Source packet: SYN-SRC-001 v1

Contrary packet: SYN-CTR-001 v1

Interviewer's exact question: "On April 10, 2026, did you personally approve the final text of fictional Memorandum A-17 before it was sent to the five recipients listed in its distribution field?"

Definitions and scope: "Approve" means personally communicate authorization to send the text. "Final text" excludes attachments. The question concerns the version time-stamped 3:15 p.m. Pacific Time and does not ask who approved Attachment 1.

Supporting source: S-001, fictional email showing "Approved to send," time-stamped 2:58 p.m.

Contrary/limiting source: C-001, fictional revision log showing Attachment 1 changed at 3:07 p.m.

PARTICIPANT STATEMENT AREA — POTENTIALLY SWORN

Response path: Qualified answer — personal knowledge and identified records.

Exact adopted statement: "On April 10, 2026, I personally approved the final text of fictional Memorandum A-17 before it was sent to the five listed recipients. My approval did not include Attachment 1, which was revised after my approval, and I do not state who approved that attachment."

Basis: Personal communication reflected in fictional source S-001. The participant adopts the described personal act; the source is evidence of the act but is not incorporated wholesale.

Qualification: Approval excluded Attachment 1. No statement is made about the attachment's approver or substantive accuracy.

Why this is better than "Yes": The standalone statement identifies the act, date, document version, recipients, and excluded attachment; it resolves the strongest contrary source without hiding the limitation; and it does not import an accusation or a conclusion about motive.